



Standards Portal

SAA's Standards Portal is designed to educate the archives community about the value and role of standards, enhance the application of standards to practice, and facilitate successful partnerships with related information standards organizations with mutual concerns and interests. The portal includes SAA-approved standards, guidelines, and best practice documents. The Society's long-term goal is to establish a comprehensive clearinghouse that includes contextual information to assist archivists and allied professionals in moving these, and other external standards, from theory into practice.

Administration and Management

- [Archival and Special Collections Facilities: Guidelines for Archivists, Librarians, Architects, and Engineers](#)

Provides guidance on site evaluation and construction of archival facilities that meet the needs of staff and researchers to ensure the preservation of archival collections.

- [Best Practices for Internships as a Component of Graduate Archival Education](#)

Suggested guidelines for graduate students, archival educators, and archivists serving as intern supervisors.

- [Best Practices for Volunteers in Archives](#)

Suggested guidelines for archives institutions and organizations about the use of volunteers; of interest to individuals who are considering volunteer work in an archives institution or organization.

- [Guidelines for Accessible Archives for People with Disabilities](#)

These Guidelines provide recommendations and suggest resources to help archivists provide services and spaces that are accessible and inclusive. They encourage respect for each person's right of physical control of their own body, assistive devices and related accommodations.

About Archives

What Are Archives?

Standards

- [Development & Review](#)
- [SAA-Developed Standards](#)
- [Standards Creation/Revision Outline](#)
- [Endorsement of External Standards](#)
- [Proposal for Inclusion of Non-Endorsed Standard](#)

Archival Organizations

Archival Consultants

Resources

Standards: What's New!

[Guide to Implementing Rights Statements from RightsStatements.org](#)

[Handling and Storage of Audio and Video Carriers](#)

[Guidelines on the Production and Preservation of Digital Audio Objects](#)

[Safeguarding the Audio Heritage: Ethics, Principles, and Preservation Strategy](#)

- [Guidelines for College and University Archives](#)

These guidelines discuss the definition of college and university archives, as well as the administrative relationships, records management, core archival functions, facilities and equipment, and supporting services involved.

- [Guidelines for Evaluation of Archival Institutions](#)

Provides an objective and consistent framework against which archives can measure their development, recognizing the diversity of both archival institutions and archival media.

- [Guidelines for Standardized Holdings Counts and Measures for Archival Repositories and Special Collections Libraries](#)

These guidelines were developed to provide archivists and special collections librarians with a set of practical, well-defined counts and measures that can be used to quantify and communicate holdings information.

- [Museum Archives Guidelines](#)

Assists all types of museums—both independent museums and those contained within larger institutions—in the development and administration of archives programs. The document outlines the components of a successful museum archives program.

- [Standardized Statistical Measures and Metrics for Public Services in Archival Repositories and Special Collections Libraries](#)

Developed to help archival repositories and special collections libraries quantify in meaningful terms the services they provide their constituencies and evaluate the effectiveness and efficiency of the operations that support those services.

- Browse [External Administration and Management Standards](#)

The **Standards Portal** is maintained by the **SAA Standards Committee**.

SAA Members: Contribute related resources (e.g., journal articles, case studies, etc.) by using the links at the bottom of listed standards.

Other Related Resources

- List of [Major Standards and Guidelines Adopted by SAA from 1972 to 1994](#)
- [Standards for Archival Description: A Handbook \(1994\)](#)

Developed with support from



Accessioning, Acquisitions, and Appraisal

- [Archival Accessioning Best Practices](#)

Maintained by the SAA Accessioning, Acquisitions, & Appraisal Section, these best practices were developed to provide archival workers with guiding principles as well as methods and practices for accessioning archival materials.

- [Guidelines for Reappraisal and Deaccessioning](#)

Establishes a step-by-step approach to reappraisal and deaccessioning in archival repositories and outlines general steps, problems, and solutions yielding responsible and ethical reappraisal and deaccessioning decisions.

Arrangement and Description

- [Describing Archives: A Content Standard \(DACS\)](#)

An output-neutral set of rules for describing archives, personal papers, and manuscript collections that can be applied to all material

types, DACS represents the U.S. implementation of international standards (i.e., ISAD[G] and ISAAR[CPF]) for the description of archival materials and their creators.

- [Encoded Archival Context - Corporate bodies, Persons, and Families \(EAC-CPF\)](#)

Maintained by SAA in partnership with the Berlin State Library, the EAC-CPF Schema is a standard for encoding contextual information about persons, corporate bodies, and families related to archival materials using Extensible Markup Language (XML).

- [Encoded Archival Description \(EAD\)](#)
Encoded Archival Description is a non-proprietary standard for the encoding of finding aids for use in a networked (online) environment.
- Browse [External Arrangement and Description Standards](#)

Digitization

- Browse [External Digitization Standards](#)

Education

- [Guidelines for a Graduate Program in Archival Studies](#)
The Guidelines for a Graduate Program in Archival Studies serve as a benchmark against which graduate programs in archival studies may be measured. These guidelines establish minimum standards for archival education programs in terms of mission, curriculum, faculty, and infrastructure.
- [Guidelines for Archival Continuing Education](#)
The purpose of these guidelines, developed for individuals and organizations that provide or sponsor archival continuing education, is to encourage the creation of opportunities for lifelong learning within the archival community.

Ethics, Values, and Legal Affairs

- [Orphan Works: Statement of Best Practices](#)
Describes what professional archivists consider to be best practices regarding reasonable efforts to identify and locate rights holders. "Orphan works" is a term used to describe the situation in which the owner of a copyrighted work cannot be identified and located by someone who wishes to make use of the work in a manner that requires permission of the copyright owner.
- [Principles in Indigenous Archival Repatriation \(PINAR\)](#)
The SAA Archival Repatriation Committee offers this set of Principles, which aligns with the SAA Core Values Statement and Code of Ethics, and the Protocols for Native American Archival Materials, to center repatriation and ethical returns as a core responsibility for archivists and institutions with holdings pertaining to Indigenous peoples.

- Browse [External Ethics, Values, and Legal Affairs Standards](#)

Outreach and Exhibitions

- [Guidelines for Primary Source Literacy](#)
These guidelines articulate the range of knowledge, skills, and abilities required to effectively use primary sources.

Preservation

- Browse [External Preservation Standards](#)

Records and Information Management

- Browse [External Records and Information Management Standards](#)

Reference and Access

- [ACRL/RBMS-SAA Guidelines on Access to Research Materials in Archives and Special Collections Libraries](#)
Outlines the responsibilities for researcher access, as well as legal and institutional obligations, of a repository in preserving collections for use.
- [Guidelines for Accessible Archives for People with Disabilities](#)
These Guidelines provide recommendations and suggest resources to help archivists provide services and spaces that are accessible and inclusive. They encourage respect for each person's right of physical control of their own body, assistive devices and related accommodations.
- Browse [External Reference and Access Standards](#)

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Careers

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Career Services Commons
Professional Development
Explore a Career in Archives

Education

Annual Meeting
Continuing Education
Certificate Programs
Graduate Archival Education

Publications

Bookstore
American Archivist
Archival Outlook
In the Loop
Book Publishing
Dictionary of Archives Terminology
Case Studies

Advocacy

Public Policy
Public Awareness
Within Your Institution
Crisis + Disaster Response
A*CENSUS II
Suggest SAA Advocacy Action
Archives Change Lives

Membership

Join / Renew
Resources
Groups
SAA Connect
Students
Leader Resources

